- The first known ruler of Magadha was Bimbisara, followed by his son Ajatashatru. Mahapadma Nanda started the Nanda dynasty.
- The invasion of north-west India by Alexander in 326 BCE opened up trade with the West. After the death of Alexander, Chandragupta founded the Mauryan Empire.
- The three notable Mauryan rulers, Chandragupta, Bindusara and Ashoka, established a centralised state. The system of Mauryan administration came to light through the accounts of *Arthasastra* and *Indica*.
- Mauryan Empire set in a new phase in Indian history as trade and commerce grew manifold during this period.
- Mauryan Empire continued the earlier tradition of consolidation of the empire. The truly revolutionary change that was attempted was Ashoka's exhortations to his officials and people to follow *dhamma*, abjure violence and lead a moral life.
- Mauryan Empire marked a distinct phase in Indian history with significant advances in technology and economic and social development, and created the framework for a large, centrally administered, state.

EXERCISE

NM1Q9

I. Choose the Correct Answer

1. Brahmi script in Ashoka's pillar inscription was deciphered by _____.
   (a) Thomas Saunders
   (b) James Prinsep
   (c) Sir John Marshal
   (d) William Jones
2. The first known ruler of Magadha was _____ of the Haryanka dynasty.
   (a) Bimbisara (b) Ajatashatru
   (c) Ashoka (d) Mahapadma Nanda
3. A comprehensive historical chronicle in Pali from Sri Lanka serving as an important source for the Mauryan Period is _____.
   (a) *Mahavamsa* (b) *Deepavamsa*
   (c) *Brahmanas* (d) *Mudrarakshasa*
4. The play _____ by Visakadatha describes Chandragupta and his accession to the throne of the Magadha Empire.
   (a) *Mudrarakshasa* (b) *Rajatharangini*
   (c) *Arthasastra* (d) *Indica*
5. Megasthenes'work _____describes the court of Chandragupta and his administration.
   (a) *Indica* (b) *Mudrarakshasa*
   (c) *Ashtadhyayi* (d) *Arthasastra*
6. The _____ was a prescriptive text for good administration.
   (a) *Arthasastra* (b) *Indica*
   (c) *Rajatharangini* (d) *Mudrarakshasa*

II. Write Brief Answers

1. How did Bimbisara extend the territory of Magadhan Empire?
2. Write a note on Mahapadma Nanda.
3. What made Alexander the Great to restore the throne of Porus ?
4. What are the features of a centralised state?
5. Give a brief note on the literary sources for the study of Mauryan state.
6. In what ways did the invasion of Alexander make a watershed in Indian history?

III. Write Short Answers

1. Mention the urban features revealed by archaeological findings.
2. Explain the features of the monarchies or kingdoms on the Gangetic plains.
3. Highlight the impact of the invasion of Alexander the Great on India.
4. What do you know of Ashoka's campaign against Kalinga?
5. Discuss the extensive trade on textiles carried on during the Mauryan period.

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